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E3 Reading – Exam Prep Lesson 3: Ordering tasks and a timed practice paper – Handouts

Handout 3A: Hawa's Morning

Hawa got up at six o'clock. Before breakfast, she washed her son's school shirt. After they ate, she took him to school. Then she caught the bus to college. She arrived late because the bus broke down on the way. At lunchtime she phoned the school to check on her son.

Number the events from 1 to 6 in the order they happened.

Event	Number
Hawa and her son ate breakfast.	
Hawa phoned the school.	
Hawa got out of bed.	
The bus stopped working.	
Hawa washed a shirt.	
Hawa left her son at school.	

Handout 3B: Alphabetical order

Section 1. Write the alphabet here: _____

Section 2. Write each set of words in alphabetical order in the table.

Set 1: market, bus, hostel, teacher, garden

Set 2: college, class, canal, card, cycle

Set 3: street, station, stop, student, stall

	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

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Handout 3C: Practice paper

Name: _____ Date: _____

Read the text and answer all the questions. You have 40 minutes.

The Garden Behind the Hostel

1 Behind a hostel in Hackney there is a small garden. Two years ago it was only a yard full of rubbish. Today it grows tomatoes, beans, herbs and flowers. The people who live in the hostel made it themselves.

2 The idea came from Lucia Moreno. She moved into the hostel in January and missed her mother's garden in Colombia. In March she asked the manager, Mr Bailey, if residents could use the yard. **He** agreed, but he said there was no money for it.

3 First, Lucia and five neighbours cleared the rubbish. It took them two weekends. Then a local garden centre gave them soil and some old tools. In April they planted the first seeds in wooden boxes. They watered them every evening after dinner.

4 The summer was difficult. In June, snails ate most of the young plants, and the group had to start again. In July there was no rain for three weeks. However, nobody gave up. By September they had enough vegetables to cook a meal for the whole hostel.

5 The garden has done more than produce food. Residents who never spoke to each other now work side by side. Children help with the watering. "People are calmer," says Mr Bailey. "They have something to look after."

6 Next year the group plans to build a small greenhouse. Lucia could move to a flat soon, but she will come back to visit. "I planted this garden," she says. "I want to see it grow."

Question 1. Who is 'He' in paragraph 2? Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. Lucia's father
- B. Mr Bailey
- C. A neighbour
- D. A worker at the garden centre

Question 2. What is the main point of paragraph 4? Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. London usually has bad weather.
- B. The group had problems but carried on.
- C. Snails are dangerous for vegetables.
- D. The hostel cooked dinner together every week.

Question 3. Put these events in the order they happened. The first one is done for you.

Event	Order
Lucia came to live at the hostel.	1
Snails destroyed many plants.	
Lucia asked for permission to use the yard.	
Everyone in the hostel shared food from the garden.	
The neighbours took the rubbish away.	
The group put seeds into boxes.	

Question 4. How did the group get their soil? Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. Mr Bailey paid for it.
- B. They bought it at a market.
- C. A nearby business donated it.
- D. Lucia's family sent it.

Question 5. In paragraph 4, what does 'gave up' mean? Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. stopped trying
- B. went home
- C. got angry
- D. felt tired

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Question 6. The text: Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. advertises a garden centre
- B. describes how some neighbours built a garden
- C. warns people about snails
- D. advises readers how to grow tomatoes

Question 7. Write these words in alphabetical order: garden, flowers, greenhouse, group, food

	Word
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	

Question 8. In paragraph 6, what does ‘could’ mean? Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. must
- B. might
- C. wants to
- D. did

Question 9. Which sentence is correct? Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. The garden cost the hostel a lot of money.
- B. Lucia built the garden alone.
- C. There was a dry period in the summer.
- D. The first seeds went in during January.

Question 10. Write two problems the gardeners had in the summer.

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